USER MANUAL

FOR

MILESTONE

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1. Introduction

Welcome to Milestone — your personal productivity companion! This user manual will guide you through everything you need to know to install, set up, and use the Milestone application effectively.

Milestone is a free desktop application that helps students and young professionals manage their daily tasks and long-term goals all in one place. It works completely offline, stores all your data privately on your own computer, and is designed to be simple and easy to use from day one.

1.1 Who Is This Manual For?

This manual is written for:

- Students and young professionals who will be using Milestone to manage their tasks and goals.
- Anyone installing Milestone for the first time.
- Users who need help with a specific feature.

1.2 What Milestone Can Do For You

- Create a personal account that only you can access.
- Add daily tasks with titles, descriptions, and due dates.
- Track which tasks you have completed and which are still pending.
- Set long-term goals with deadlines to keep yourself motivated.
- See your progress at a glance on the dashboard.
- Keep all your productivity tools in one single application — no subscriptions, no internet required.

1.3 Important Note About Passwords

Milestone does not have a 'Forgot Password' feature in this version. Please remember your password carefully. If you forget your password, you will need to create a new account. Your password is securely encrypted and cannot be recovered even by the developer.

2. System Requirements

Before installing Milestone, make sure your computer meets the following requirements:

Requirement	Minimum Specification

Computer	Desktop or laptop computer
Operating System	Windows 10 or 11 / macOS 10.15 or newer / Linux Ubuntu 20.04+
Processor	Intel Core i3 or equivalent
RAM (Memory)	At least 4GB
Storage	At least 200MB free disk space
Screen Resolution	Minimum 1280 x 720 pixels
Java	Java 17 or newer (must be installed)
MySQL	MySQL 8.0 or newer (must be installed)
Internet	Only needed during initial installation of Java and MySQL

3. Installation Guide

Follow these steps carefully in order. Do not skip any step — each one is required for Milestone to work correctly.

3.1 Step 1 — Install Java

Milestone is built using Java, so Java must be installed on your computer before you can run it.

1. Open your web browser and go to: https://www.java.com/en/download/
2. Click the Download Java button.
3. Once the installer downloads, double-click it to run it.
4. Follow the on-screen instructions and click Install.
5. When installation is complete, click Close.

To verify Java installed correctly:

6. Press Windows + R on your keyboard, type cmd and press Enter.
7. In the black window that opens, type: java -version and press Enter.
8. You should see something like: java version "17.0.x" — this confirms Java is installed.

3.2 Step 2 — Install MySQL

MySQL is the database that stores all your Milestone data on your computer.

9. Go to: https://dev.mysql.com/downloads/installer/
10. Download the MySQL Installer for Windows (choose the larger file, around 400MB).

11. Run the installer and choose Setup Type: Developer Default.
12. Click Next and then Execute to install all components.
13. During configuration, you will be asked to set a root password — choose a password you will remember and write it down. You will need this password when setting up Milestone.
14. Complete the installation and click Finish.

3.3 Step 3 — Set Up the Milestone Database

This step creates the database that Milestone will use to store your data.

15. Open MySQL Workbench from your Start menu.
16. Click on Local instance MySQL80 to connect. Enter your root password when prompted.
17. Click the + icon at the top to open a new SQL tab.
18. Copy and paste the following SQL script into the tab:

```
CREATE DATABASE IF NOT EXISTS milestone_db;
USE milestone_db;
CREATE TABLE IF NOT EXISTS users (
   user_id INT AUTO_INCREMENT PRIMARY KEY,
   username VARCHAR(50) NOT NULL,
   email VARCHAR(100) NOT NULL UNIQUE,
   password_hash VARCHAR(255) NOT NULL,
   created_at TIMESTAMP DEFAULT CURRENT_TIMESTAMP
);
```

19. Click the lightning bolt button (or press Ctrl+Enter) to run the script.
20. You should see a success message at the bottom of the screen.
21. To confirm it worked, run: SHOW TABLES; — you should see users, goals, and tasks listed.

3.4 Step 4 — Run the Milestone Application

22. Locate the milestone.jar file provided with this application.
23. Make sure MySQL is running on your computer (check that the MySQL80 service is active in Windows Services).
24. Double-click milestone.jar to launch the application.
25. If double-clicking does not work, open Command Prompt, navigate to the folder containing the JAR file, and run: java -jar milestone.jar
26. The Milestone splash screen will appear, followed by the login screen.

4. Using Milestone

4.1 Creating an Account

If you are using Milestone for the first time, you need to create an account.

27. On the login screen, click the Create Account button.
28. The registration window will open. Fill in all four fields:
    - Username — your display name (e.g. Annie)
    - Email — your email address (must contain @)
    - Password — at least 6 characters
    - Confirm Password — type your password again to confirm
29. Click Register.
30. A success message will appear: 'Account created successfully! You can now log in.'
31. Click OK and you will be returned to the login screen.

Common registration errors:

- 'All fields required' — make sure all four boxes are filled in.
- 'Please enter a valid email' — your email must include an @ symbol.
- 'Password must be at least 6 characters' — use a longer password.
- 'Passwords do not match' — retype both passwords carefully.
- 'An account with this email already exists' — use a different email or log in with your existing account.

4.2 Logging In

32. On the login screen, type your registered email address in the Email field.
33. Type your password in the Password field (it will appear as dots for privacy).
34. Click the Login button or press Enter on your keyboard.
35. If your details are correct, the main Milestone dashboard will open.

If login fails, you will see: 'Invalid email or password, try again!' — check that your email is correct and your password has no typos.

4.3 Navigating the Application

Once logged in, you will see the main application window with three sections in the left sidebar:

- Dashboard — your overview screen showing task and goal statistics and your overall progress.
- Tasks — where you manage all your daily tasks.
- Goals — where you manage all your long-term goals.

Click any of these buttons to switch between sections. Your logged-in username and email are shown in the status bar at the bottom of the screen.

4.4 Managing Tasks

Adding a Task

36. Click Tasks in the left sidebar.
37. Click the + Add Task button.
38. Fill in the task details:
    - Title (required) — a short name for your task, e.g. 'Study for exam'
    - Description (optional) — more details about the task
    - Due Date (optional) — type the date in YYYY-MM-DD format, e.g. 2026-05-15
39. Click Save. Your task will appear in the list immediately.

Marking a Task as Complete

40. Click on the task in the list to select it (it will be highlighted).
41. Click the ✓ Mark Complete button.
42. The task status will change to ✅ Complete.

Marking a Task as Incomplete

43. Click on a completed task to select it.
44. Click the ↩ Mark Incomplete button.
45. The task status will revert to ⏳ Incomplete.

Deleting a Task

46. Click on the task you want to delete to select it.
47. Click the 🗑 Delete Task button.
48. A confirmation message will appear: 'Are you sure you want to delete this task?'
49. Click Yes to delete or No to cancel.

4.5 Managing Goals

Adding a Goal

50. Click Goals in the left sidebar.
51. Click the + Add Goal button.
52. Fill in the goal details:
    - Title (required) — a name for your goal, e.g. 'Complete Java certification'
    - Description (optional) — more details about your goal

- Deadline (optional) — type the date in YYYY-MM-DD format

53. Click Save. Your goal will appear in the list.

Deleting a Goal

54. Click on the goal you want to remove to select it.
55. Click the 🗑 Delete Goal button.
56. Confirm deletion by clicking Yes.

Note: Deleting a goal does not delete tasks that were linked to it. Those tasks will remain in your task list.

4.6 Using the Dashboard

The Dashboard is your home screen and gives you a quick overview of your productivity. It shows four stat cards:

- Total Tasks — the total number of tasks you have created.
- Completed — how many tasks you have marked as complete.
- Total Goals — the total number of goals you have set.
- Active Goals — how many goals are still in progress.

Below the cards, a progress bar shows your overall task completion percentage. This updates automatically every time you mark a task complete or incomplete.

4.7 Logging Out

57. Click the Logout button at the bottom of the left sidebar.
58. A confirmation message will appear: 'Are you sure you want to logout?'
59. Click Yes. The main window will close and the login screen will appear.

Your data is automatically saved every time you make a change — there is no manual save button needed.

5. Troubleshooting

Problem	Solution
Application does not open when I double-click the JAR file	Make sure Java is installed. Open Command Prompt and run: java -version. If Java is not found, reinstall it from java.com.

'Could not connect to database' error appears	MySQL is not running. Open Windows Services (type services.msc in the Run dialog), find MySQL80, and click Start.
I cannot log in even with the correct password	Make sure Caps Lock is off. Passwords are case-sensitive. If you still cannot log in, create a new account.
I forgot my password	Unfortunately there is no password reset feature in Milestone v1.0. You will need to create a new account with a different email address.
My tasks or goals are not showing	Check that you are logged in to the correct account. Each account only shows its own data.
The application is running slowly	Check that MySQL is running properly. Restart the MySQL80 service in Windows Services.
Date format not accepted when adding a task or goal	Enter dates in the format YYYY-MM-DD only. For example: 2026-12-25 for December 25th 2026.
The application window is too small	The application should launch in full screen automatically. If it does not, press the maximise button at the top right of the window.
Database connection error on a new machine.	Open DatabaseConnection.java, update the PASSWORD field to match your MySQL root password, and rebuild the JAR file.

6. Frequently Asked Questions

Is Milestone free to use?

Yes. Milestone is completely free. There are no subscription fees, no premium features, and no hidden costs.

Does Milestone need internet to work?

No. Milestone works completely offline. Internet is only needed once during the initial installation of Java and MySQL.

Is my data private?

Yes. All your data is stored locally on your own computer inside a MySQL database. No data is sent to any server or third party. Your password is encrypted using BCrypt and cannot be read by anyone, including the developer.

Can I use Milestone on multiple computers?

Not in this version. Since data is stored locally, your tasks and goals are only accessible on the computer where Milestone is installed. A future version may support data synchronisation.

What happens if I delete a goal? Do my tasks get deleted too?

No. Deleting a goal only removes the goal itself. Any tasks that were linked to that goal will remain in your task list — they will simply no longer be associated with a goal.

Can multiple people use Milestone on the same computer?

Yes. Each person can create their own account on the same installation of Milestone. Each account's data is completely separate and private from other accounts on the same computer.

7. References

1. Oracle Corporation. (2023). Java SE 17 Documentation. https://docs.oracle.com/en/java/javase/17/

2. MySQL. (2023). MySQL 8.0 Reference Manual. https://dev.mysql.com/doc/refman/8.0/en/

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